

How to introduce yourself in ADVANCED (C1) English

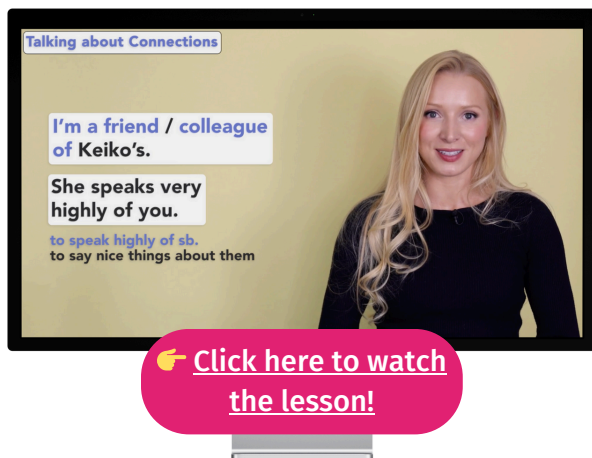
Always introducing yourself the same way? This lesson will help you sound more natural — and much more advanced — when meeting new people. You'll learn polite phrases, clever conversation starters and some light-hearted expressions that'll make your English feel smoother and make you feel more confident. I've prepared example sentences, pronunciation tips, a bonus dialogue, and a quiz to make sure everything sticks. By the end of this lesson, you'll have a whole new set of tools to introduce yourself with ease!

A quick note before we begin!

This lesson includes audio dialogues to help you practise listening and hear how natural, everyday introductions really sound. To get the full experience, I recommend watching the video lesson or listening along as you work through the PDF.

I've also included the full transcript of each dialogue, so you can read along if you like — but do make sure you listen to the audio to hear the phrases in action!

Click the button below to open up the video!



Dialogue #1

Alex: Hi, I'm Alex. Nice to meet you.

Claire: Claire. Nice to meet you, too.

Alex: What are you doing here?

Claire: I sell cheese. You?

Alex: I'm with the marketing team.

Now, there's nothing wrong with that exchange. In fact, I've had hundreds of conversations like that! But we're focusing on C1 English today, so let's learn some more advanced phrases.

● Beginning an Introduction

Alright, how do you begin? You could say -

I don't think we've been introduced.

I'm not sure we've met before.

You can use these phrases even if you're quite sure that you haven't met before. They're just polite introductory phrases.

● Introducing Someone Else

If you want to introduce someone else, you might say -

I'd like to introduce...

Have you met...

more formal

less formal

- **"I'd like to introduce** my colleague, Karson Cheng."

- **"Have you met** Julie? She's a mate from school."

● Sharing Your Name

When you introduce yourself, you need to share your name. It's probably the most important thing! It's fine to just say -



- I'm Lucy.

But you could expand a little, especially if you use a shortened version of your name or you have a nickname. Here are some phrases to use:

I'm Magdalena, but most people call me Magda.
My name's Roberto but I usually go by Beto.
I go by... = I use this name.
Please, call me Pati. It's short for Patricia.
Bartholomew's my given name , but only my grandmother calls me that! I've always felt more like a Bart.
I respond to William or Will, but never Bill!

● Talking about Connections

Now, let's say you know you have a mutual connection with someone. You could say -

- **I'm a friend / colleague of** Keiko's.
 - You might add → She **speaks very highly of you**.
 - **to speak highly of sb.**
to say nice things about them

And the **most common responses** are -

All good, I hope!
Should I be worried?!
Don't believe a word of it!
It's good to put a face to the name. → It's good to finally see the person whose name I've heard many times.

Now, let's say you might have met someone before but don't remember clearly. You can say:

- I think **our paths have crossed before**.

This phrase is perfect when you vaguely recognise someone but aren't entirely sure where from. When you cross paths with someone, or your paths cross, it means you've met by chance at some point.

If you're in a similar social or professional circle, say:

- We must **move in the same circles**.

And if you're surprised that you haven't met sooner, you might add -

- I can't believe we **haven't crossed paths before!**

● Where Are You From?

So, next, you might want to ask someone where they're from. You could say -

- **Are you from around here?**

And here are some **different ways to answer**:

Yep. Portsmouth born and bred .
Yeah, I was born and raised just around the corner. → born and grew up in a place
Originally, but I've moved around a lot. I'm based in Milan at the moment.
I grew up here, but I've been living in Belfast for the past few years.
No, just passing through . → to stop in a place for a short time before going somewhere else

● Why Are You Here?

Let's say you introduce yourself to someone at an event. You could ask, 'Why are you here?' but that's very direct, so here are some alternatives:

- **What brings you here today?**

- What brings you to this part of the world?
- What brings you to the conference today?

You might add -

- **Business or pleasure?**

For example:



● Likes, Interests and Hobbies

Did you notice that additional detail - **'I'm a bit of a caffeine addict.'** We often add something about our likes, interests and hobbies when we're introducing ourselves. **'I'm a bit of a/an...'** is a common expression used to soften a statement about ourselves. It suggests we have a certain trait or interest but in a more casual or modest way. For example:

- **I'm a bit of a** foodie.
- **I guess you could say I'm a bit of a** bookworm.
- **I consider myself a bit of a** language geek.

You could also say that you have or have got a soft spot for something or someone. This means 'I like it or them.'



You'll often hear people refer to themselves as a 'geek' but **I don't recommend calling someone else that!**

- I've got a **soft spot for** stray cats and now I have 7 at home.
- I've always had a **soft spot for** cheesy 80s music.

Dialogue #2

Alex: Hi, I don't think we've been introduced. I'm Alexandra but I usually **go** by Alex.

Claire: Nice to meet you. I'm Claire. So, what **brings** you here today?

Alex: I'm with the marketing team organising this event. What about you? Business or **pleasure**?

Claire: A bit of both! I'm here on holiday, but I sell cheese back in London, so I thought I'd pop in.

Alex: You know, I think our **paths** have crossed before, actually. Were you at the Cheddar Together conference in Melbourne?

Claire: Yeah, I was. We must move in the same **circles**. So, are you a bit of a cheese addict, too?

Alex: Yeah, you could say that!

Bonus Dialogue!

Callie: Hi, I'm not sure we've met. I'm Callie. Callie Rogers.

Tim: Hi, Timothy Broadbent. Tim, **for short**. Callie Rogers... you're not Louis White's friend, are you?

Callie: Um, yeah, that's me. Sorry, have we met before? I've got an appalling memory for faces.

Tim: No, no, don't panic! Louis just talks about you a lot. He **speaks very highly of you**. It's great to **put a face to the name**.

Callie: Ah, small world! So, you must be into tech, then?

Tim: Yep, I guess you could say **I'm a bit of a** technophile!

BONUS

If you'd like to practise what you've just learnt, click the link below for interactive activities designed to help you use these phrases naturally!

👉 [Click here to access the exercises!](#)



Quiz

For each question, choose the correct answer from the options provided.

1. Which phrase would you use to politely suggest you haven't met someone before?

- a) I guess you could say I'm a bit of a foodie.
- b) I think our paths have crossed before.
- c) I don't think we've been introduced.

2. Which is a more formal way to introduce someone else?

- a) Have you met Priya?
- b) I'd like to introduce my colleague, Priya Singh.
- c) Priya's a mate from uni.

3. Which of these could you say if you know someone through a mutual friend?

- a) I'm a friend of Jamie's.
- b) I grew up just down the road.
- c) I'm based in Cardiff now.

4. What's a polite way to ask where someone is from?

- a) What's your address?
- b) Are you from around here?
- c) Where do you live?

5. Which of these responses shows you were born and grew somewhere?

- a) Just passing through!
- b) Originally, but I live elsewhere now.
- c) London born and raised!

6. What does "move in the same circles" mean?

- a) Live in the same city.
- b) Work in the same building.
- c) Share similar social or professional groups.

7. Which response would you expect after saying, "I've heard a lot about you"?

- a) All good, I hope!
- b) I don't think we've met.
- c) Just passing through!

8. Which phrase would you use to let people know what to call you?

- a) I'm Sophia, but most people call me Soph.
- b) I respond to William or Will, but never Bill!
- c) Both of the above.

Answers:

1.b, 2.b, 3.a, 4.b, 5.c, 6.c, 7.a, 8.a

